

Groups and Groupings

The Moodle 'Groups' feature allows you to divide up the students on your course into groups. Students can then undertake Moodle activities within these groups, allowing them to work together more closely, and encouraging more participation from each member than they might get in a whole-class exercise.

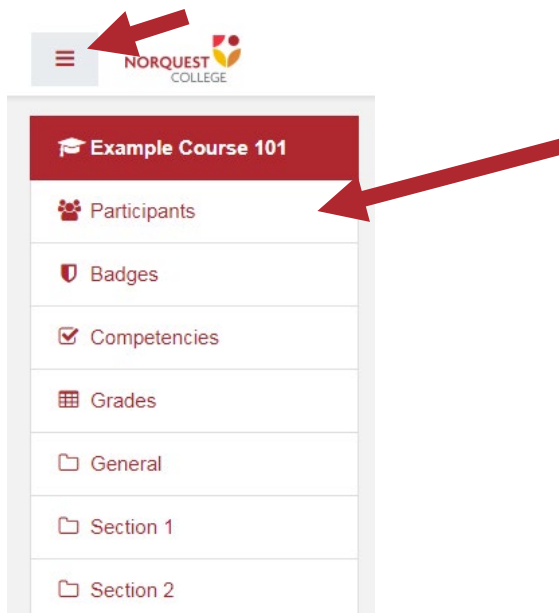
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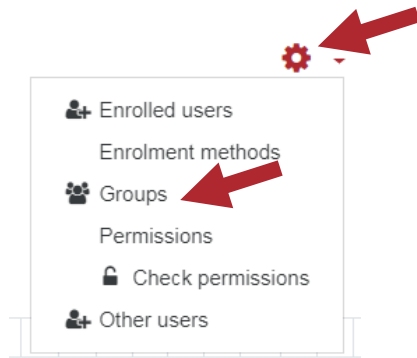
Groups

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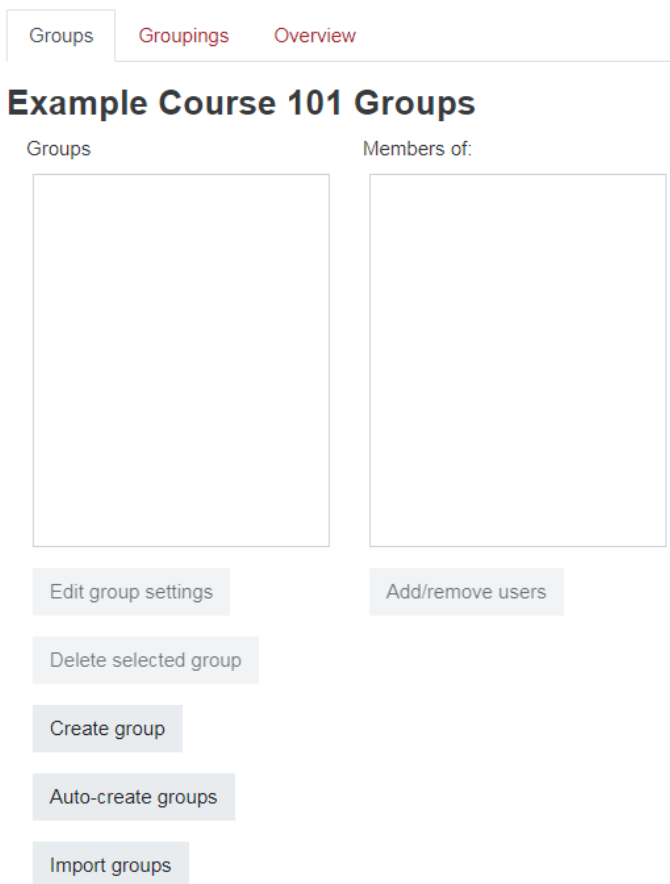
1. Locate the **Navigation pane** for your course on the left side of your course page. If it isn't already open, click the hamburger button on the top left hand side (beside the NorQuest logo) to reveal the pane. Click on '**Participants**'.



2. Click on the '**Settings**' button on the top right hand side of the Participants list, and then click on '**Groups**'.



3. You will see a screen with two columns: Groups & Members. If no groups have been set up, both columns will be empty.



4. Create each group by clicking the **'Create Group'** button, typing a name into the Group name field and clicking **'Create group'**. (The other fields are optional – see 'Further Group Settings' below.) Select **'Save changes'**. The new group then appears in the left-hand column.

Group name ❗

Group ID number ❗

Group description

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☷
🔗
🔄
🖼️
📎
🎤
📺
📄

Enrolment key ❗ Click to enter text ✎ 👁

Hide picture

New picture ❗ Maximum size for new files: 500MB

5. To Add users to the Groups, select the group name and select '**Add/remove users**'. The names of the students and faculty enrolled in the course will appear. Select the names of the participants you want in the group and select '**Add user**'.

Group members

None

Search

◀ Add

Remove ▶

Potential members

Teacher (3)
Melanie Mattila
Test Mel
Joan Wall

Student (2)
NQC Test1
NQC Test2

Search

Group members will appear on the right panel.

Group members

Student (2)

NQC Test1

NQC Test2

Search

Clear

Alternatively, you can allocate students to groups automatically using a Group Enrolment key in activities that you have created in your course.

6. Select **Back to Groups**.

7. Repeat steps #4 and #5 until your groups are complete!

Note: If you do not put some students into a group, they will be put in a group together by default.

Groupings

The Moodle 'Groupings' feature allows you to have different groups for activities. This allows students to experience working with other peers in a group setting.

1. Follow the steps for adding a group above to create student groups. You cannot create groupings without creating groups first.
2. After you have created groups, click on the 'Groupings' tab. This will take you to a page with a list of all the existing groupings. Click on '**Create grouping**'.



3. Give the grouping a name (required), and a description (if desired).
4. You will then be taken back to the Groupings main page with your new grouping listed. Click on the '**Show groups in grouping**' icon underneath the '**Edit**' heading.

Groupings

Grouping	Groups	Activities	Edit
Cohort 1	None	0	  

[Create grouping](#)

5. You will now see two boxes – the one on the left contains the groups within the grouping, and the one on the right lists all the possible groups that can be added to the grouping. Click on a group and then click the '**Add**' button to add it to the grouping. When you are done, click the '**Back to groupings**' button.

Add/remove groups: Cohort 1

Existing members: 0

Potential members: 4

Group A
Group B
Group C
Group D

◀ Add

Remove ▶

Group Submissions Settings

When creating assignments, you will need to set group submissions settings.

Students submit in groups: One student submits for the entire group. A group submission will be shared among group members and all members of the group will see each other's changes to the submission.

Require group to make submission: (Recommended) Only students in a group are able to make a submission.

Require all group members submit: All students must click the "Submit" button

Group submission settings

Students submit in groups		Yes ▾
Require group to make submission		Yes ▾
Require all group members submit		No ▾
Grouping for student groups		None ▾

Restrict Access to Groups

To restrict an activity to a certain grouping, click the 'Update' button for that activity and navigate to the 'Common modules settings' section. You will need to select 'Separate groups' or 'Visible groups' in the groups setting before you can change the groupings setting.

Group modes

There are three group modes

- **No groups** - There are no sub groups, everyone is part of one big community
- **Separate groups** - Each group can only see their own group, others are invisible.
- **Visible groups** - Each group works in their own group, but can also see other groups.
(The other groups' work is read-only.)

For example, enabling either separate or visible groups on an assignment drop-box enables staff to filter the student submissions to see only those from a particular tutor group. With visible groups, students can see which other groups are doing the same activities as they are; with separate groups, they do not know which other groups are doing the same activities.

Using groups with discussion forums allow teachers to restrict interaction between students. Separate groups mean only students in the same group can see and participate in discussions within a particular forum. Visible groups allow students to see other group's discussions, but only participate in their own group's discussions.

Note: Where visible groups are used or the participant can access all groups, the user's own group is shown first, followed by other groups

If you have any questions or require further assistance, please contact
Moodle Help at moodle@norquest.ca